

Diabetes Mellitus – Medical Summary

Overview

Diabetes mellitus is a chronic metabolic condition characterized by elevated blood glucose levels. It can occur when the body does not produce enough insulin, does not effectively use insulin, or both.

Common Types

Type 1 diabetes involves immune-mediated destruction of insulin-producing pancreatic cells. Type 2 diabetes commonly involves insulin resistance and reduced insulin production. Gestational diabetes develops during pregnancy.

Common Symptoms

Increased thirst, frequent urination, increased hunger, fatigue, blurred vision, slow-healing wounds, and unexplained weight changes may occur.

Diagnosis

Healthcare professionals may evaluate diabetes using tests such as fasting blood glucose, HbA1c, oral glucose tolerance testing, and random blood glucose testing.

Management

Management may include balanced nutrition, regular physical activity, blood glucose monitoring, weight management, and medicines prescribed by a healthcare professional.

Possible Complications

Poorly controlled diabetes may increase the risk of cardiovascular disease, kidney disease, nerve damage, eye problems, and foot complications.

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